

Xiaochuan Li

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Computational cognitive science and language model interpretability. Research interests:
language, reasoning, and human and artificial cognition.

EDUCATION

University of Technology Nuremberg

Nuremberg, Germany

M.Sc. Human and Artificial Intelligence

Oct. 2025 – exp. 2027

Selected coursework: Cognitive Psychology; Foundations in Psychology & Empirical Study Design; Deep Learning; Interpretability for Natural Language Processing.

University of Marburg

Marburg, Germany

Preparatory studies: German for graduate study

2024 – 2025

Shenzhen University

Shenzhen, China

B.A. Philosophy

2020 – 2024

Selected coursework: Logic; Mathematical Logic; Analytic Philosophy; Psychology of Reading; Cognition and Learning Disabilities.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Moral framing and dilemma choices in language models

2026–27

Year-long project course · with M. Roth (UTN) and S. Ostermann (DFKI)

Investigated how moral wording affects dilemma choices. Designed and ran controlled experiments and activation interventions in 7B and 14B models for the utilitarian-framing branch, with checks of answer labels, option positions, and task understanding; manuscript in preparation.

Modal language in preschool children

2026 –

M.Sc. thesis, design stage · with C. Grosse Wiesmann (UTN) and T. Hopf (MPI CBS Leipzig)

Developing a study comparing preschool children's understanding of modal language with nonlinguistic reasoning about possibilities. The modal-language component forms part of an ongoing PhD project at MPI CBS Leipzig; data collection has not started.

Fact-checking after ChatGPT exposure

Winter 2025–26

Course study, Foundations in Psychology and Empirical Study Design

Co-designed a between-subjects study of optional checking after ChatGPT or Wikipedia answers; adopted for a class-wide experiment (49 participants; 47 analysed). Conducted the individual data analysis and prepared a course report.

Cross-lingual ProtoBias

Summer 2026

Single-author course project

Held image pairs fixed while varying prompt language across seven languages to evaluate judgments in two VLM families (about 12,600 judgments). Completed a single-author course report with code.
report · code

Typicality in referent choice: what the description leaves open2026

Independent theoretical study

Distinguishes three conditions for typicality in referent choice and the limits of what a forced-choice task can establish.

Li, X. (2026). Working paper. [lingbuzz/010343](#) · [doi:10.5281/zenodo.22855036](#)

Three Ways of Leaving p Unsettled2026 –

Formal semantics and pragmatics · analysis in development

Compares might p, might p or might not p, and I don't know whether p by the replies each licenses.

Street-view country classificationSummer 2026

Team course project, Deep Learning

My part: CNN training, ablations, and performance analysis.

Leibniz's logical system and characteristica universalis2024

Undergraduate thesis · Shenzhen University · supervisor: Zang Yong

Analysed Leibniz's metaphysics, logic and proposal for a universal symbolic language.

Learning difficulties in primary-school childrenSep.–Dec. 2021

Invited research project · Shenzhen Learning Disorders Association and Yucai No. 2 Primary School

Prepared character-reading materials, administered timed assessments, and analysed response data to support the assessment of learning difficulties; contributed to teaching items and individual learning plans.

EMPLOYMENT

University of Technology NurembergNuremberg, Germany

IT Service Desk (part-time)Apr. 2026 – present

Delivered student IT onboarding and individual support; handled system installation, service reporting, and inventory.

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming Python (PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, pandas, scikit-learn), Git, LaTeX

Methods PsychoPy/Pavlovia, JASP; probing, activation patching, steering (working proficiency)

Languages Mandarin Chinese (native), German (C1), English (C1), Japanese (learning)